RAFAEL MORETTI-KLEIN

Senior / Staff Backend Engineer | Python, Go & Distributed Systems

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 21 years of experience building production services and large-scale distributed systems, primarily in Python and Go. Designed and wrote most of a Go entitlement service handling 120,000 requests per second at peak, led technical work on a customer-facing playback API, and contributed to migrating a Python monolith into approximately 60 services. Recent hands-on coding has focused on internal tools and Python cost-dashboard scripts. Experienced with PostgreSQL/PostGIS, Cassandra, Kafka, Kubernetes, Terraform, automated testing, and production observability.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, C++
Backend and APIs: FastAPI, Tornado, Django, Flask, asyncio, gRPC, Protobuf
Databases and messaging: PostgreSQL, PostGIS, Cassandra, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ
Cloud and infrastructure: GCP (GKE, Pub/Sub, BigQuery), Kubernetes, Terraform; AWS (EC2, S3)
Testing and observability: pytest, Python test harnesses, Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry
Additional: Distributed systems design, architecture reviews, technical documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Engineering, Platform | Streamhaus GmbH, Munich *2019 – August 2026*

- Led the platform organisation across five teams, with 45 engineers and five engineering managers; areas included identity, playback API, billing integration, and developer platform.
- Drove the strangler-fig migration of a Python 2 monolith into approximately 60 Python 3 and Go services on GKE; playback API availability improved from 99.5% to 99.95%.
- Established a service template for Python and Go services, including OpenTelemetry tracing, Prometheus metrics, and Terraform modules.
- Built Python scripts and an internal cost dashboard using BigQuery billing exports and Looker Studio; rightsizing and committed-use discounts reduced cloud spend by 31% (€4.2M per year).
- Introduced an RFC process, architecture review board, and on-call guidelines adopted company-wide.

Principal Engineer | Streamhaus GmbH *2015 – 2019*

- Served as technical lead for the playback API, using Python, Tornado, Cassandra, and Redis.
- Designed and wrote most of a Go entitlement service for subscriptions, regions, and devices; it handled 120,000 requests per second at peak with p99 latency under 15 ms, using Cassandra and local in-memory caching.
- Co-authored the company's service template and Python style guide.

Senior Software Engineer | Nordfels Telematik AG, Stuttgart *2010 – 2015*

- Built backend services ingesting GPS data from 300,000 vehicles using C++, Python, PostgreSQL/PostGIS, and RabbitMQ.
- Led a team of six developers on the route-history product.
- Co-inventor on a granted German patent for adaptive GPS sampling in vehicle fleets.

Software Engineer | Dataquelle Systems GmbH, Karlsruhe *2005 – 2010*

- Developed C++ and Python for industrial data acquisition software on Linux and embedded x86.
- Built a Python test harness used by QA for eight years.

SELECTED ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Open-source maintainer | Python retry library, 2012–2018

- Maintained a Python retry library that reached approximately 1,500 GitHub stars; handed over maintenance in 2018.

EDUCATION

Dipl.-Inf. (equivalent to MSc), Computer Science | Rhine Valley University, 2005

PUBLICATIONS & TALKS

- "Running Python at 100k rps" — conference talk, 2018
- "Cost is a feature" — internal platform engineering summit keynote, 2023

LANGUAGES

German (native) | Italian (native) | English (fluent)